



Beyond ChatGPT

5 Free AI-powered Windows apps

Every AI laptop should have them

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AI-capable laptops, like those with Intel Core Ultra or AMD Ryzen AI chips, let you run powerful tools locally: transcribing meetings, generating art, editing, enhancing webcam feeds, and talking to GPT-style assistants.

For reference, I tested all of these on an ASUS Zenbook S14 OLED equipped with Intel Core Ultra 7 258V and 32GB RAM. Here are five free, no-signup-needed apps, each with clear, step-by-step setup instructions:

1. Whisper – Local Speech-to-Text

Transcribe meetings, videos, or voice notes offline using OpenAI's Whisper model. It is packaged into a very easy-to-use local app.



How to install & use Whisper.cpp on Windows:

- **Get the Windows build**
 - Download “whisper.cpp” from GitHub (use a community-built Windows binary)
- **Download a model**
 - Copy “ggml-base.en.bin” (or another size/model) into a “models” folder inside your “whisper.cpp” directory.
- **Convert any audio**

- Use FFmpeg (free) to convert your audio into a compatible WAV format, 16kHz sample rate and mono channel, which is ideal for AI transcription tools like Whisper. to convert your file, run this command in Command Prompt:

```
ffmpeg -i input.mp3 -ar 16000 -ac 1 output.wav
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```

■ Run transcription

- Open Command Prompt in your “whisper.cpp” folder and run:


```
whisper_cpp.exe -model models\ggml-base.en.bin output.wav
```
- A .txt transcript appears automatically.

You'll get offline transcription in minutes without any internet.

2. GIMP + Stable Diffusion Plugin – AI Art & Inpainting

GIMP is already a powerful free alternative to Photoshop, but with the Stable Diffusion plugin, it becomes an AI playground. You can generate images from text prompts, upscale low-res photos, and use inpainting to edit specific areas of an image.

Inpainting allows you to mask or select a region of the image, like an unwanted object, a blank face, or background, and tell the AI what to replace it with. For example, you can select a person's outfit and replace it with something entirely new, or fix parts of an old photo by describing what's missing. The result blends in naturally, as if it was part of the original image.

How to add AI to GIMP:

